

INITIAL LANGUAGE EVALUATION REPORT

Marlène Schumacher

Candidate: Marlène Schumacher
Job Title: Collaborateur — Fieldfisher
Interview Date: 23 June 2026
Report Date: 23 June 2026
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Final Evaluation Report — Legal English Coaching

Interviewer: Joss Frimond, Linguaid France

Professional Context

Marlène Schumacher is a practising avocat at Fieldfisher, working within a **litigation (contentieux)** practice. At collaborateur level, she operates in a demanding professional environment where English is a regular and significant part of her working week, accounting for approximately **40% of her weekly activity**. In addition to French and English, Marlène has a background in **German**, which reflects a strong multilingual disposition and suggests an established capacity for language acquisition.

Her daily professional use of English spans a broad range of high-stakes communication contexts, including drafting professional correspondence, attending client meetings, participating in negotiations, and delivering presentations. This level of exposure places clear and immediate demands on both her written and spoken English competencies.

Needs Identified

Based on the needs-analysis interview, the following professional communication priorities were identified:

- **Professional emails** — drafting clear, appropriately formal correspondence in a litigation context
- **Client meetings** — participating confidently and fluently in discussions with English-speaking clients and counterparts
- **Negotiations** — using precise, persuasive, and tactically appropriate language under pressure

- **Presentations** — structuring and delivering arguments and case updates clearly in spoken English

These are all areas where linguistic imprecision or lack of confidence carries direct professional risk, both reputationally and in terms of client service quality.

Current Level & Key Gaps

Marlène's current level of English is assessed at approximately **B1+**, based on the needs-analysis interview. This places her at an intermediate level with emerging competencies in professional contexts, but not yet at the level of consistency and precision required for high-level legal practice in English.

The following gaps were identified as priorities for development:

- **Spoken production (Expression orale)** — Difficulty expressing legal arguments and professional positions fluently and with sufficient accuracy in real-time spoken interaction
- **Listening comprehension (Compréhension orale)** — Challenges in fully processing fast-paced, accent-varied, or technical spoken English, particularly in meeting and negotiation contexts
- **Written production (Expression écrite)** — Inconsistencies in tone, register, and legal drafting conventions when writing in English
- **Legal vocabulary (Vocabulaire juridique)** — Gaps in domain-specific terminology, particularly within litigation and procedural contexts
- **Confidence and fluency (Confiance / aisance)** — A recurring inhibitor across all skill areas, likely compounding the above gaps and affecting overall communicative effectiveness

It is worth noting that the written assessment data from the initial evaluation was incomplete; however, the interview-based assessment provides a sufficiently reliable foundation for programme design at this stage.

Learning Objectives

By the end of the recommended programme, Marlène should be able to:

- Draft **clear, well-structured professional emails** in appropriate legal register, including correspondence relating to litigation matters

- **Participate actively and confidently** in client meetings and internal discussions conducted in English
- Use **negotiation language strategically** — making proposals, expressing positions, responding to counterarguments, and managing impasse
- **Deliver structured oral presentations** on legal matters with clarity, logical organisation, and professional fluency
- Apply a broader and more precise **legal vocabulary** relevant to contentieux and general litigation practice
- Operate with greater **communicative confidence**, reducing hesitation and self-censorship in spoken and written contexts

Recommendation

Parameter	Detail
Programme	E360_LEGAL
Current Level	B1+
Target Level	B2
Recommended Hours	30 hours
Proposed Start Date	29 June 2026
Financing	CPF

The **E360_LEGAL programme** is strongly recommended for Marlène. This programme is well-suited to her profile as a litigation practitioner with frequent, multifaceted English usage, and will address all identified priority gaps through a legal-context-specific, skills-integrated approach. The 30-hour programme provides sufficient scope to achieve meaningful and measurable progress from B1+ to B2, with targeted work on spoken interaction, written production, and legal terminology.

Given Marlène's German language background and her already significant weekly exposure to English, she is well-positioned to make efficient progress within this framework. An early start date of **29 June 2026** is advisable, given the immediate professional demands she faces.

Sign-off

This report has been prepared on the basis of a needs-analysis interview conducted by Linguaid France. It reflects a professional assessment of communicative level and learning needs rather than a formally administered psychometric evaluation.

Interviewer: Joss Frimond

Organisation: Linguaid France

This document is confidential and intended solely for the use of the candidate and the relevant programme coordinators at Linguaid France.